



PURUSHOTTAM DIWAKAR

RUNNING DRY

Sanwlia, Rajasthan

RAJIV GANDHI DRINKING WATER MISSION

Budget allocation for 2008-09
Rs 7,300 crore

DISTINCTION

PASS

FAIL

Geeta, 30, was happy to pay Rs 500 for a connection and Rs 50 as monthly charges for regular water supply in her house, before the taps in her village Sanwlia went dry. "It is very difficult to bring water from the public hand pump," she says. Under Swajal Dhara scheme, started in 2002 as part of Rajiv

SHAILESH RAVAL

Gandhi National Drinking Water Mission to provide drinking water in villages, 80 households in Sanwlia received tap water till four months back when a tiff between the sarpanch and committee chairman led to disruption in the supply. Those are not the only clashes. Disputes between the Central and the state governments adversely affect the progress of the scheme. The Centre does not provide for any escalation in cost and insists that it has to be borne by the people or the state government. Also, many villagers find the Rs 50 to Rs 100 charged per month for water supply (besides installation cost)

MIXED BAG: Geeta (in yellow) near the hand pump (above); children at an Anganwadi centre in Tarapur

steep. According to an estimate, 70 per cent of the projects under this scheme have not been completed. Of those completed, only 40 per cent have been taken over by village bodies while others remain unutilised. **by Rohit Parihar**

CHILD SUPPORT

Tarapur, Gujarat

INTEGRATED CHILD DEVELOPMENT SERVICES

Budget allocation for 2008-09
Rs 6,300 crore

DISTINCTION

PASS

FAIL

If the 2,200 people of Tarapur, a poor village in Gujarat's Gandhinagar district, were to vote on the Union Government's Integrated Child Development Services (ICDS) programme or Anganwadi, as it is popularly known as, perhaps they would all give it a thumbs up. The scheme aims at tackling malnourishment among small children and lactating mothers. Gita Prajapati, 22, a farm labourer's wife who has a five-month-old son, gets food at the nearby Anganwadi centre as it helps in breastfeeding. "I have been able to feed my newborn well only thanks to the centre," she says. Each child gets 50 gm of fortified flour, 15 gm of gram and 5 gm of oil per day from which the helper prepares dishes like sukhi. Not surprisingly, while 77 children go to the Anganwadi, only 30 go to the Balwadi school where children do not get food. **by Uday Mahurkar**

